

22.7 KEY LANGUAGE "WAS" / "WERE" NEGATIVES

As in the present simple, use "not" to form negative statements in the past simple.

He { **was not** / **wasn't** } a teacher in 2004.



They { **were not** / **weren't** } at the park yesterday.



You can contract these negatives to their short forms.

Add "not" after "was" or "were."



22.8 KEY LANGUAGE "WAS" / "WERE" QUESTIONS

To ask questions about the past using the verb "to be," swap the subject and verb.

He **was** in India.



Was he in India?

Swap the subject and "to be."

They **were** late for school.



Were they late for school?



22.9 FURTHER EXAMPLES "WAS" / "WERE" NEGATIVES AND QUESTIONS

I **wasn't** a good waiter.



Were there any cakes at the party?



There weren't any boats.



Was he good at playing tennis?



22.10 CROSS OUT THE INCORRECT WORD IN EACH SENTENCE

He **wasn't** / ~~**weren't**~~ a doctor.

1 They **wasn't** / **weren't** very good at science.

2 I **wasn't** / **weren't** in Canada in 2002.

3 You **wasn't** / **weren't** at the party last night.

4 We **wasn't** / **weren't** in our house last year.

5 There **wasn't** / **weren't** a restaurant near the river.

